

SALES · OUTBOUND

Cold Email Warm-up + Reply Detector

Rotate sends across a small pool, score every inbox reply with Claude, route hot ones to Slack and cold ones to a nurture list. Stops the silence-equals-progress trap.

THE PROBLEM

Your cold campaign is sending. You have no idea what's coming back.

You drop 500 emails a week through Instantly or Smartlead. The platform tells you open rates and 'positive reply' counts that mean nothing. Real replies are mixed in with auto-responders, unsubscribes, and the occasional 'who are you'. Your SDR forwards three a day and misses the buyer who said 'maybe Q3'. Warm-up runs but you can't see if it actually changed deliverability. Both holes cost real revenue.

200hrs

SDR TIME TRIAGING REPLIES / YR

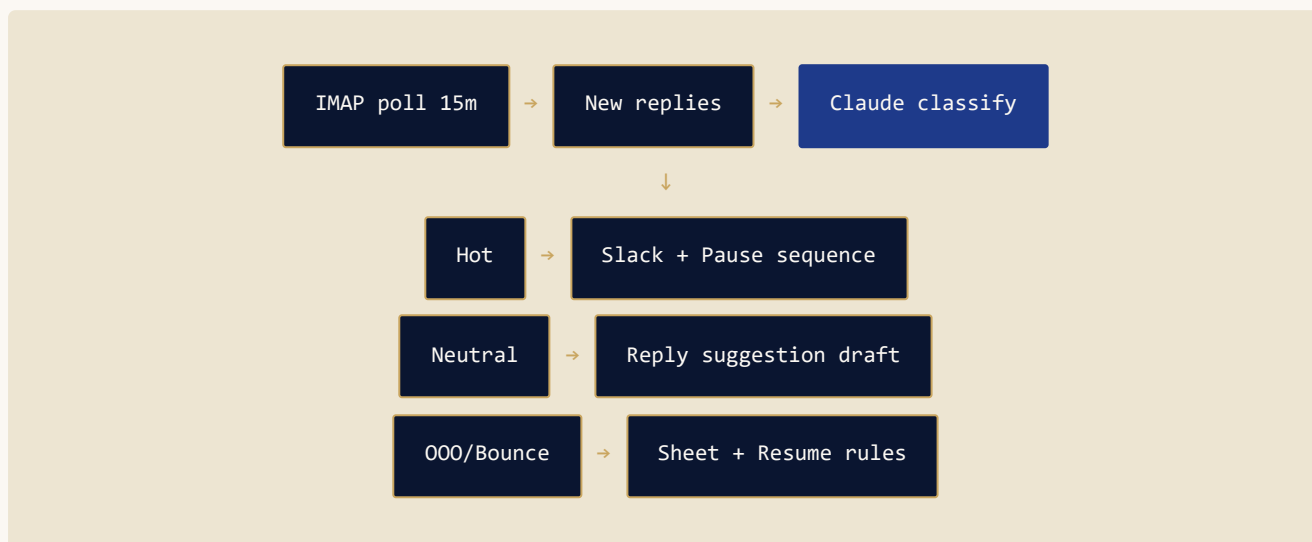
40%

HOT REPLIES MISSED OR STALE

Built for

- B2B outbound teams running cold email at any volume
- Founders doing founder-led sales who can't afford an SDR yet
- Agencies running cold email FOR clients (white-label this)

The flow



BUILD IT

Stack & setup

Tech stack

LAYER	TOOL	COST/MO
Orchestration	n8n (self-host / cloud)	\$6-20
Sending tool	Instantly / Smartlead / Lemlist (existing)	\$30-97
Inbox access	IMAP node (any inbox, no extra cost)	\$0
LLM classifier	Claude Sonnet 4.6	\$5-12
Alerts	Slack + Google Sheets	\$0
Total (added)	—	\$11-32

Before you import

- n8n instance (DO \$6/mo or n8n.cloud)
- Existing cold email tool (Instantly, Smartlead, Lemlist) — this layer reads its inbox, doesn't replace it
- IMAP credentials for each sending inbox (Gmail app password or Outlook OAuth)
- Anthropic API key with \$15+ credit
- Slack channel #cold-email-hot + bot token
- Google Sheet with columns: received_at, from, subject, snippet, classification, score, next_action

Setup (60 min single inbox, +15 min per added inbox)

1. Spin up n8n and confirm you can reach it on a public URL
2. Add Gmail/Outlook app password OR OAuth for each sending inbox
3. n8n credentials: IMAP for each inbox, Anthropic API, Slack OAuth, Google Sheets OAuth
4. Workflows → Import from Clipboard → paste the JSON from page 4
5. Edit the Claude prompt with YOUR offer, ICP, and what counts as 'hot' for your team
6. Test with a known reply → confirm classification + Slack ping + Sheet row
7. Activate workflow. Optional: add a second IMAP node per sending inbox

COPY + PASTE

n8n workflow JSON



Copy from GitHub →

One click. Opens raw file with native copy button.



SCAN ON
MOBILE

Or import the file 03-cold-email-warmup-reply-detector.json from the pack folder. In n8n: **Workflows** → **Import from Clipboard / File**.

```
{
  "name": "03 - Cold Email Warm-up + Reply Detector",
  "nodes": [
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        "rule": {
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            { "field": "minutes", "minutesInterval": 15 }
          ]
        }
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      "id": "trigger-cron",
      "name": "Every 15 min",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.scheduleTrigger",
      "typeVersion": 1.1,
      "position": [200, 300]
    },
    {
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        "options": {
          "customEmailConfig": "[\\"UNSEEN\\"]"
        }
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      "name": "Fetch new replies (IMAP)",
      "type": "n8n-nodes-base.emailReadImap",
      "typeVersion": 2,
      "position": [420, 300],
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          "name": "Sending inbox IMAP"
        }
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    },
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        },
        "messages": {
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            {
              "text": "You classify replies to cold email outreach for SkynetLabs.\n\nMY OFFER: Automation + AEO retainers and one-off Fiverr builds ($297-997 builds, $1.5K-5K retainers).\n\nClassify the reply into ONE category:\n- HOT: positive intent, asking for call/pricing/next step\n- WARM: 'maybe later', 'send more info', 'not now but Q3'\n- COLD: polite no\n- OOO: out-of-office auto-reply\n- BOUNCE: mail server bounce /
```

WANT THIS BUILT FOR YOU?

Three ways forward

Most teams can wire this in an afternoon. Some can't — or shouldn't waste their best hour on it. If that's you:

Done-for-you build

I install + customize this exact flow on your n8n. 7-day delivery. 30-day fix-it warranty.

\$297-997

FIVERR

Free 20-min audit

I review your stack + name the 3 highest-leverage automations for your business. No pitch.

Free

EMAIL

Monthly retainer

Fractional ops engineer for your stack. Slack-first, 48h SLA. Agencies + 8-fig brands.

\$1.5K-5K

EMAIL

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